

Customer Retention Playbook v3.2

XLVentures.AI | Customer Success Platform | Internal Use Only

1. Purpose and Scope

This playbook governs all retention actions taken by Customer Success Managers (CSMs) at XLVentures.AI. It applies to all B2B SaaS accounts regardless of plan tier. The goal is to reduce churn, improve Net Revenue Retention (NRR), and ensure every at-risk customer receives a structured, timely response.

All CSMs must follow this playbook when an interaction is classified as a Renewal Concern or Cancellation Risk. Deviations require VP of Customer Success approval.

2. Health Score Definitions

XLVentures.AI uses a 0-100 health score updated weekly based on product usage, support ticket volume, billing compliance, and engagement frequency.

Score 80-100 : HEALTHY - standard quarterly check-in cadence

Score 60-79 : WATCH - increase touchpoints to monthly

Score 40-59 : AT-RISK - immediate CSM outreach required within 5 business days

Score 0-39 : CRITICAL - escalate to Senior CSM + VP within 48 hours

Health scores below 40 combined with a renewal date within 30 days automatically trigger Rule CS-15: Executive Business Review (EBR) protocol.

3. Churn Signal Classification

CSMs must classify every at-risk interaction into one of three churn signal tiers:

TIER 1 - LOW SIGNAL

Signals: Single complaint resolved, feature request not yet on roadmap, minor billing question.

Action: Reply within 24 hours. Log interaction. No escalation required.

TIER 2 - MEDIUM SIGNAL

Signals: Two or more unresolved complaints, usage drop > 30% in 30 days, team lead departure, negative NPS response.

Action: CSM outreach within 48 hours. Schedule a check-in call. Update health score manually.

TIER 3 - HIGH SIGNAL (Cancellation Risk)

Signals: Explicit competitor mention, renewal non-commitment, usage drop > 50%, executive escalation request.

Action: Initiate EBR within 48 hours. Involve VP of Customer Success. Prepare retention offer.

4. Rule CS-03 - Onboarding Delay Response

Trigger: Customer reports that onboarding took longer than the committed SLA (standard SLA is 7 business days).

Required actions within 24 hours:

1. Send written apology acknowledging the delay.
2. Identify root cause (internal delay, data migration issue, customer-side delay).
3. If delay was caused by XLVentures.AI: offer 10-15% discount on next invoice or 1 month free.
4. Assign dedicated CSM for 60-day monitoring period.
5. Log in CRM with tag: ONBOARDING_DELAY.

Do not dismiss the complaint without a goodwill offer if the delay exceeded 5 business days and was caused internally.

5. Rule CS-07 - Low Module Adoption

Trigger: Customer using fewer than 50% of contracted modules after 60 days of onboarding.

Required actions:

1. Schedule a Product Adoption Review call within 5 business days.
2. Identify which modules are unused and understand barriers.
3. Assign a training session for unused modules - minimum 2 sessions.
4. Send post-session resource pack (guides, video walkthroughs, use case examples).
5. Set 30-day adoption target with the customer.
6. If adoption does not improve after 30 days: escalate to Tier 2 churn signal.

Note: Customers using fewer than 3 modules after 90 days are 3x more likely to churn at renewal.

6. Rule CS-11 - Key Contact Departure

Trigger: Customer notifies CSM that their primary point of contact or platform administrator has left the company.

Required actions within 48 hours:

1. Send a Knowledge Transfer Package: admin setup guide, recorded training sessions, quick-start checklist.
2. Offer a free 1-hour onboarding call for the new administrator.
3. Request the name and email of the new primary contact within 5 business days.
4. Update CRM contact records immediately.
5. Increase check-in frequency to bi-weekly for 60 days.
6. Flag account as TRANSITION_RISK in the health dashboard.

Rationale: Accounts that lose their primary platform champion within 6 months of onboarding have a 47% higher churn rate at next renewal (XLVentures.AI internal data, 2025).

7. Rule CS-15 - Executive Business Review (EBR) Protocol

Trigger: Health score < 40 AND renewal date < 30 days AND any Tier 3 churn signal present. Also triggered when customer explicitly mentions competitor evaluation.

EBR must be scheduled within 48 hours of trigger. VP of Customer Success must attend.

EBR agenda must include:

1. Value delivered summary: ROI achieved, modules adopted, support tickets resolved.
2. Acknowledgement of all outstanding complaints with resolution commitments.
3. Product roadmap preview: share upcoming features relevant to customer's stated needs.
4. Commercial options: renewal discount (up to 20%), payment flexibility, additional seats pricing.
5. Clear ask: request renewal commitment or specific objections to be addressed.

Post-EBR actions:

- Send written summary within 24 hours of the call.
- If customer commits: process renewal, send confirmation, set success milestones.
- If customer is still undecided: schedule a 72-hour follow-up call.
- If customer churns: initiate exit interview and churn analysis report.

8. Competitor Evaluation Response

When a customer mentions they are evaluating a competitor, do not minimize or ignore the concern.

Recommended response framework (ACE):

- A - Acknowledge: Thank them for being transparent. Do not be defensive.
- C - Clarify: Ask which specific gaps are driving the evaluation. Listen fully before responding.
- E - Evidence: Present specific examples of value delivered to their account. Reference usage data and resolved issues.

Do not:

- Disparage the competitor by name.
- Make promises that cannot be committed to in writing.
- Pressure the customer with urgency tactics.

If the customer names a specific competitor feature as a blocker, escalate to Product team within 24 hours with the customer feedback tagged.

9. Retention Offers - Approval Matrix

CSMs may offer the following without additional approval:

- 10% discount on renewal invoice
- 1 month free credit
- Free training sessions (up to 3)
- Extended payment terms (net-60 instead of net-30)

Senior CSM approval required for:

- 11-20% renewal discount
- 2 months free credit
- Custom SLA commitments

VP of Customer Success approval required for:

- Discounts > 20%
- Contract restructuring
- Commitments on unshipped product features